

Campus Policies & Academic Regulations Handbook 2025-2026

Northgate Institute of Technology | Governance, Academic Integrity, Student Conduct & Privacy

1. Institutional Charter, Legal Basis & Scope of Governance

Northgate Institute of Technology ('the University') is an autonomous institution of higher learning committed to advanced engineering education, scientific inquiry, technological innovation, and ethical leadership. Founded in 1982 under state government ordinance and subsequently granted autonomous status by the University Grants Commission (UGC) in 1999, the University has grown into one of South Asia's premier technical institutions with an enrollment exceeding 12,000 undergraduate, postgraduate, and doctoral scholars across four residential campuses.

This Campus Policies and Academic Regulations Handbook is enacted under the statutory authority of the Board of Governors and the University Academic Senate to establish uniform standards of scholarship, community welfare, civic responsibility, and institutional governance across all academic faculties, research centers, specialized laboratories, and residential facilities. The provisions herein are updated annually by the Office of the Registrar in consultation with the Dean of Academic Affairs, the Dean of Student Welfare, and the Faculty Senate. All amendments require a two-thirds majority vote of the Academic Senate and formal ratification by the President of the University before they take effect in any subsequent semester.

All academic policies, administrative rules, and disciplinary procedures contained herein comply with applicable national regulations, including UGC guidelines, All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE) norms, the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act 2016, the Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH) at Workplace Act 2013, and statutory data-confidentiality standards functionally equivalent to the US Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA). The governance structure operates through a bicameral framework: the Board of Governors (responsible for fiduciary oversight, capital planning, and executive leadership) and the Academic Senate (responsible for curricular standards, degree requirements, faculty appointments, and ethics).

2. Comprehensive Code of Academic Integrity & Honor Pledge

Academic honesty is the foundational pillar of all scholarly pursuits at Northgate Institute. Every student, upon matriculation, signs and accepts the University Honor Pledge: 'I pledge on my honor that I have neither given nor received unauthorized aid in this academic work, that all sources and intellectual contributions have been truthfully acknowledged, and that I uphold the highest ethical standards in all assignments, examinations, laboratory experiments, and research activities.' Violations are adjudicated by the Departmental Academic Integrity Committee (DAIC) and the Central Disciplinary Board (CDB).

The University's academic integrity framework is grounded in the UGC (Promotion of Academic Integrity and Prevention of Plagiarism in Higher Educational Institutions) Regulations, 2018, supplemented by the AICTE task-force advisory on AI disclosure (2024). Core prohibited practices and their prescribed institutional responses include:

- **Plagiarism and Verbatim Copying:** Submitting source code, technical reports, homework assignments, or research papers without explicit attribution constitutes plagiarism. The University employs automated similarity engines (MOSS, JPlag, Turnitin with AI-detection). A non-attributable similarity index exceeding 25% in non-boilerplate logic triggers mandatory DAIC review. UGC tier thresholds apply: 10-40% similarity requires revision and resubmission within 6 months; 40-60% bars resubmission for one academic year; above 60% may result in cancellation of registration. Faculty assigning coursework must run all submissions through the university's designated detection portal within 5 days of the submission deadline.
- **Generative AI & LLM Usage Policy (Effective August 2025):** Utilizing large language models (LLMs) or generative AI tools (ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, Claude, Gemini, etc.) for graded coursework is strictly prohibited unless the course instructor explicitly authorizes specific use in the published course syllabus. When authorized, students must provide an 'AI Usage Appendix' detailing all prompts submitted, tool model and version, output used, and the substantive intellectual modifications made by the student. Core theses, original data interpretation, algorithms designed by the student, and laboratory experiment analysis must be entirely the student's own intellectual work regardless of LLM authorization. AI-generated content flagged above 20% by AI-detection tools triggers mandatory review under Clause 5.7 of the Disciplinary Matrix.
- **Unauthorized Collaboration & Repository Sharing:** Sharing private code repositories, laboratory solution files, assignment source, or exam prompts with current or future cohort students constitutes a Level 2 integrity violation. Public posting of assignment solutions on platforms such as GitHub, Chegg, or Stack Overflow within the same academic year of the assignment's validity is treated equivalently.
- **Examination Malpractice & Identity Fraud:** Bringing unauthorized notes, smart devices, wireless earphones, or other communication apparatus into examination halls, or facilitating another student's impersonation in any form of assessment, leads to immediate course cancellation (all units), one-semester suspension, and a permanent conduct notation on the official transcript.

- **Digital Infrastructure Integrity:** Unauthorized port scanning, SQL-injection probing, denial-of-service attempts, man-in-the-middle packet sniffing, or keystroke-logging against university servers, faculty portals, examination systems, or research databases constitutes a Level 3 violation carrying permanent IT access revocation, immediate academic suspension, and mandatory criminal referral to law enforcement under the Information Technology (Amendment) Act 2008 and Indian Penal Code Section 66.
- **Research Misconduct:** Fabricating experimental data, falsifying laboratory observations, misrepresenting statistical results, or engaging in salami-slicing of publications in funded research projects constitutes research misconduct under the University's Research Ethics Charter. All funded research activities must obtain prior clearance from the Institutional Research Ethics Committee (IREC) before data collection commences.

3. Attendance Regulations, Absence Verification & Medical Condonation

Regular class engagement and active laboratory participation are prerequisites for academic success. All undergraduate B.Tech and postgraduate M.Tech programmes mandate a minimum attendance of 75% in each registered theory course and 80% in each laboratory-practical course to qualify for the End-Semester Examination. These thresholds align with AICTE's minimum instructional contact norms (90 teaching days per 15-week semester). Condonation for attendance shortages in the 65%-74% bracket is permissible only for: (a) documented hospitalization confirmed by the University Chief Medical Officer; (b) verified institutional duty representation at national or international events; (c) participation in AICTE-recognized national competitive examinations (GATE, CAT, GRE). Condonation applications must be filed no later than 5 working days after the cause of absence ends. Students with attendance below 50% receive a mandatory 'Detained' (DE) grade and must repeat the course in its entirety in the next available offering.

Absence due to medical reasons requires certified documentation from the University Health Center Chief Medical Officer within 5 working days of resuming classes. Private medical certificates are subject to verification. For institutional duty — technical competitions, cultural fests, sports meets, academic conferences, or industry delegations — the sponsoring department must submit an Institutional Duty Leave notification to the Registrar at least 7 days prior to travel. Retroactive duty-leave applications are not accepted under any circumstances. Faculty instructors maintain real-time biometric and RFID-based attendance records through the Digital Course Management Portal (DCMP v3.0). Students receive automated SMS and email alerts when cumulative attendance falls below the 80% threshold, triggering mandatory advisor notification.

4. Academic Grievance & Multi-Stage Grade Appeal Procedures

Students who believe their final course grade was calculated incorrectly, applied without reference to the published rubric, or awarded through demonstrable procedural bias may seek formal redress through the University's three-stage appeal mechanism:

- **Stage 1 — Informal Faculty Review (Deadline: 5 Working Days Post Grade Publication):** The student requests a direct consultation with the Course Instructor of Record, presenting specific written documentation of the alleged error or inconsistency. The instructor must respond in writing within 3 working days.
- **Stage 2 — Departmental Review Committee (Deadline: 10 Working Days Post Stage 1 Response):** A formal written petition is submitted to the Head of Department, who appoints a three-member Faculty Review Committee that inspects all graded materials, verifies computation against the rubric, and issues a binding written determination within 7 working days.
- **Stage 3 — Standing Academic Appeals Board (Final; Deadline: 15 Working Days Post Stage 2):** Final institutional appeal adjudicated by a five-member board comprising the Dean of Academic Affairs (chair), Controller of Examinations, and three senior faculty members. The board reviews all prior documentation and may request oral presentations. Its decision is final, binding on all parties, and cannot be further appealed within institutional channels.

Critical note: Mere disagreement with an instructor's exercise of academic judgment on subjective creative or analytical questions does not constitute valid grounds for Stage 3 adjudication. The appellant bears the burden of proving procedural error, computational mistake, or verifiable rubric non-compliance.

5. Anti-Ragging Directives, Zero Tolerance Policy & Statutory Campus Safety

Northgate Institute enforces an absolute Zero Tolerance Policy toward ragging. In compliance with the Hon'ble Supreme Court of India's directives in SLP (C) No. 24295/2006 and UGC (Prevention, Prohibition and Punishment of Ragging in Higher Educational Institutions) Regulations 2009, ragging is a cognizable criminal offense under Sections 339, 340, 341, 342, and 506 of the Indian Penal Code. Any student engaging in physical abuse, verbal harassment, emotional coercion, cyber-bullying, or forced participation in degrading acts against fellow scholars faces: (a) immediate suspension from all academic activities; (b) expulsion from residential hostels; (c) forfeiture of all scholarships and financial aid; (d) mandatory filing of an FIR with local police. The 24/7 Anti-Ragging Squad conducts surprise inspections across all hostel blocks, common areas, canteens, and transport vehicles.

Every incoming student and their parent/guardian must complete mandatory online anti-ragging affidavits via the national UGC anti-ragging web portal (www.antiragging.in) as a prerequisite for hostel allotment and library access activation. Confidential complaints may be lodged via the Anti-Ragging Toll-Free Helpline (1800-180-5522), through anonymous physical dropboxes in all hostel common rooms, or electronically via the encrypted University Grievance Portal (accessible 24/7 with anonymous filing options).

6. Equal Opportunity Cell, POSH Compliance & Disability Accommodation

The University maintains an inclusive, non-discriminatory learning environment. The Internal Complaints Committee (ICC), constituted under the POSH Act 2013, investigates all grievances concerning gender-based harassment, sexual harassment, and hostile workplace conduct with absolute confidentiality. The ICC comprises the Presiding Officer (a senior woman faculty member), two faculty members committed to women's causes, two non-teaching staff members, and one external member from an NGO working on women's rights — satisfying statutory composition requirements. Written complaints must be acknowledged within 7 days and formal inquiry reports submitted within 30 days of filing. All parties are guaranteed procedural fairness, legal representation assistance, and protection from retaliation.

The Equal Opportunity Cell (EOC) provides specialized accessibility accommodations for differently-abled scholars under the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act 2016, including: assistive screen-reading software on all central computing workstations; wheelchair-accessible ramps and designated seating in all lecture theaters, laboratories, and examination halls; scribe and extra-time allowances (25% additional time) in all timed examinations; priority hostel room allocation on ground floors; and dedicated counseling from the EOC Student Accessibility Coordinator. Disability accommodations must be requested by the third week of each semester.

7. Hostel & Residential Life Regulations

Residential facilities include Sarojini Devi Hall (women, Blocks A–D, 840 rooms) and Vivekananda Hall (men, Blocks E–H, 960 rooms), accommodating approximately 3,600 resident scholars. Key conduct standards: (1) Mandatory biometric in-time is 09:30 PM weekdays and 10:30 PM weekends and gazetted holidays; (2) Possession, consumption, or distribution of alcohol, tobacco products, narcotics, or NDPS-scheduled substances is strictly forbidden and triggers immediate expulsion from hostel with FIR; (3) Unauthorized high-wattage electrical appliances (>500 W — including induction cookers, electric irons, and hair straighteners) are banned due to fire risk; (4) Quiet hours are strictly enforced 11:00 PM–06:00 AM; (5) Visitors of the opposite gender are not permitted in residential rooms under any circumstances. Violations trigger progressive disciplinary action: first offense — written warning; second offense — residential probation; third offense — permanent hostel expulsion.

Hostel rooms undergo periodic safety and maintenance inspections by the Chief Warden and resident advisors. Overnight leave requires submission through the Digital Hostel Management Portal a minimum of 24 hours in advance, with mandatory SMS confirmation from the parent or designated guardian. Weekend local leaves (within 50 km radius) require advisor endorsement. Outstation leaves exceeding 3 nights require written parental consent and Dean's approval.

8. Information Technology Acceptable Use Policy (IT-AUP 2025)

All computing resources, campus-wide Wi-Fi networks (8.4 Gbps aggregate capacity across 420 access points), licensed software platforms, cloud compute allocations, and research computing infrastructure are provided exclusively for academic, research, and authorized administrative purposes. Network credentials (LDAP accounts) are strictly non-transferable. Prohibited activities include: (a) hosting commercial servers or crypto-mining operations; (b) distributing copyrighted media, software, or proprietary research datasets without license authorization; (c) running any commercial business, e-commerce platform, or subscription service using university network bandwidth; (d) bypassing firewall configurations using unauthorized VPN tunneling or proxy services; (e) installing peer-to-peer software or BitTorrent clients on campus machines.

The IT Services Division operates a Security Operations Center (SOC) that continuously monitors network traffic, authentication sessions, and endpoint security telemetry via a SIEM (Security Information and Event Management) platform. Anomalous traffic patterns automatically trigger account suspension pending investigation. First-time minor violations (bandwidth abuse, unauthorized streaming) receive a written warning. Serious violations involving hacking, social engineering, or data exfiltration result in immediate permanent account termination, asset seizure for forensic examination, academic suspension, and mandatory referral to the Cyber Crime Cell under IT Act 2000 Section 43 and Section 66.

9. Student Rights, Representation & Co-curricular Participation

All enrolled students hold the right to: transparent academic evaluation with timely written feedback on submitted coursework; access to certified course syllabi and learning outcome mappings; participation in recognized technical chapters (IEEE-CS Chapter, ACM Student Chapter, ISTE Chapter, Robotics & Autonomous Systems Club, Cybersecurity CTF Team); representation on the Departmental Student Advisory Committee (DSAC); and petition to any institutional authority without fear of academic retaliation. Students on active academic probation or subject to pending disciplinary investigations are disqualified from holding executive offices in student council or representing the University externally.

10. Library Access, Digital Repositories & Resource Governance

The Central University Library (Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam Knowledge Center) houses over 148,000 physical volumes, maintains IEEE Xplore, ACM Digital Library, ScienceDirect, Springer, and JSTOR institutional subscriptions, and operates a 24/7 digital reading room. Borrowing entitlements: B.Tech students — 4 volumes, 14-day loan; M.Tech and Ph.D. scholars — 8 volumes, 30-day loan; faculty — 15 volumes, 90-day loan. Reference-only materials (bound theses, reserve textbooks, rare manuscripts) may not leave the premises. Overdue penalties: Rs. 10 per volume per day (waived once per semester on formal application). Unreturned materials 30 days past due trigger a Library Hold that blocks pre-registration, transcript issuance, and graduation clearance until resolved.

11. Campus Placement, Internship Eligibility & Career Services

The Department of Training & Placement (T&P;) facilitates on-campus and off-campus recruitment for graduating seniors and final-year postgraduate students. Eligibility for campus placement drives requires: (a) minimum CGPA of 6.50 on a 10-point scale; (b) zero active backlogs at the time of the specific drive; (c) clean disciplinary record with no pending CDB cases. The One-Offer Policy mandates that students accepting a Tier-1 offer (CTC > Rs. 15 Lakhs per annum) are excluded from subsequent drives to ensure equitable opportunity distribution. Dream offers (>Rs. 25 LPA) are governed by the Dream Company Policy requiring Head of Department written approval for reappearance in further drives. Mandatory 8-week summer internships must be completed between Semesters VI and VII at recognized industrial organizations or academic research labs. Students must submit completion certificates, project reports, and industry mentor evaluation forms to earn the 2 mandatory internship credits under the CBCS scheme.

12. Health Center, Mental Wellness & Medical Emergency Protocols

The University Health Center (UHC) operates 24 hours, 7 days a week, staffed by 4 resident physicians (including 1 psychiatrist and 1 orthopedic consultant), 12 nursing staff, and a dedicated campus ambulance with AED capability. All enrolled students are mandatorily covered under the University Student Health Insurance Scheme (hospitalization cover up to Rs. 3 Lakhs per annum). The Student Wellness Cell provides confidential psychological counseling, cognitive behavioral therapy sessions, stress management workshops, and crisis intervention through 6 certified clinical psychologists. Mental health services are strictly confidential; no academic or disciplinary consequences flow from voluntary self-referral.

13. Anti-Ragging Compliance, Drug Policy & Campus Safety Infrastructure

Beyond anti-ragging provisions, campus safety is maintained through: (a) installation of CCTV cameras across all academic buildings, hostel common areas, canteens, and parking zones; (b) a 24/7 Security Control Room with trained personnel monitoring all live feeds; (c) biometric access control at server rooms, research labs, and examination cell storage vaults; (d) random vehicle checks at campus entry gates by authorized security personnel. The Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) liaison officer conducts periodic awareness workshops and surprise inspections in coordination with the campus administration.

14. Environmental Sustainability, Green Campus Initiatives & Transport

Northgate Institute holds a 4-Star Green Campus Certification from the Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE). Campus sustainability initiatives include: 2.4 MW solar power generation meeting 38% of campus energy requirements; a zero-liquid-discharge sewage treatment plant; 14 electric shuttle buses serving inter-campus routes on 20-minute intervals; and a bicycle-sharing network of 320 cycles at 18 docking stations. Private petrol/diesel vehicles are restricted to outer perimeter Parking Zone B. Littering, improper e-waste disposal in non-designated bins, or damage to campus green spaces incurs mandatory community service of 10-40 hours assigned by the Green Campus Committee.

15. Student Innovation & Incubation Center (SIIC) Guidelines

The SIIC provides a structured pathway from idea to enterprise: Ideation Lab (co-working space, 60 seats), Prototype Studio (fabrication equipment, 3D printers, soldering stations), and the Scale-Up Incubator (dedicated office space for registered startups, 12 active tenants as of August 2025). Registered SIIC ventures receive: seed grants up to Rs. 5 Lakhs from the University Innovation Fund; patent filing assistance (university bears provisional filing costs up to Rs. 25,000); mentorship from the 40-member Industry Advisory Board; and access to the SIIC Alumni Investor Network (55 angel investors). Students with verified startup operations demonstrating monthly active users or revenue may petition the Academic Senate for a Startup Sabbatical of up to two semesters while retaining student status and hostel access.

16. National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 Implementation Framework

In alignment with the Government of India's National Education Policy 2020, Northgate Institute has implemented: (a) a multiple entry and exit framework allowing students to exit with a Certificate after Year 1, a Diploma after Year 2, a B.Tech after Year 3 (under the Academic Bank of Credits), or a full Honors/Research degree after Year 4; (b) Multidisciplinary Minor programmes enabling CSE students to earn a Minor in Data Science, Entrepreneurship, or Cognitive Science; (c) integration of Indian Knowledge Systems modules and Environmental Science into the mandatory humanities curriculum; (d) promotion of regional language instruction support for first-year students. The Academic Bank of Credits (ABC) account registration is mandatory for all enrolled students from AY 2025-2026.

17. Sports, Physical Fitness & Inter-Collegiate Competitions

The Sports & Physical Education Department manages facilities including 2 cricket grounds, 4 basketball courts, 6 badminton courts, a 400-meter athletics track, a 25-meter swimming pool, and a fully equipped gymnasium. Physical Education (PE) courses of 1 credit each are compulsory in Semesters I and II. Students representing the University in inter-collegiate competitions recognized by the Association of Indian Universities (AIU) receive institutional duty leave and may apply for Sports Achievement Scholarships (up to Rs. 50,000 per annum for national and above level representatives).

18. Statutory Educational Records Privacy & Data Governance

Confidentiality of Educational Records Notice: Under University Data Governance Regulations (aligned with UGC guidelines and FERPA equivalents), all student academic records — including semester grade ledgers, GPA transcripts, internal assessment sheets, fee payment balances, disciplinary dossiers, health records, and financial aid files — are classified as Confidential Educational Records. Access is restricted strictly to authorized university personnel with documented 'Legitimate Educational Interest'. Directory information (name, degree programme, branch, enrollment dates) may be published unless the student files a written Directory Information Opt-Out form with the Registrar by the second Friday of each semester. Violations of this policy by staff members constitute a disciplinary offense attracting service suspension and legal liability under applicable data-protection legislation.